

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Innovative and highly self-driven Senior Software Engineer with over 9 years of hands-on experience delivering high-performance web applications, specializing in custom WordPress and WooCommerce solutions. Proven expertise in crafting custom themes, plugins, Elementor-based websites, and headless WordPress architectures. Adept at integrating AI-driven features like chatbots and content automation scripts. Skilled in full-stack development, DevOps, performance optimization, SEO, and secure server management. Passionate about clean code, agile practices, and continuously enhancing user experiences through technology.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Frontend:** HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript (ES6+), jQuery, React, Vue.js, Elementor
- **Backend:** PHP, Node.js, Python, WordPress, WooCommerce, REST API, Shopify (Liquid), Laravel
- **DevOps & Hosting:** cPanel/WHM, Linux, Docker, NGINX, Apache, SSL, SSH, Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD
- **AI & Automation:** OpenAI APIs, Chatbots, AI content scripts, Zapier, n8n
- **Cloud & Databases:** AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, CloudFront), GCP (App Engine, Firestore), MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Firebase
- **SEO & Performance:** Yoast, caching (W3TC, WP Rocket), CDN integration, Lighthouse audits
- **Other Tools:** Figma, Trello, Slack, Jira, Postman, WP-CLI, REST/GraphQL APIs

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Sensidev

September 2021 – December 2024

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Led development of custom WordPress themes for enterprise clients, utilizing PHP, hooks, filters, and ACF Pro to deliver dynamic, modular content experiences.
- Developed Elementor-based design systems and reusable templates, optimizing workflows for designers and reducing delivery time by over 30%.
- Built and integrated advanced WooCommerce stores with subscription, multilingual, and multi-currency support, scaling sales by over 40%.
- Integrated OpenAI and HuggingFace APIs to power AI chatbots and automatic content generation features in WordPress admin.
- Created custom REST API endpoints for WooCommerce to sync external CRMs and ERP systems in real-time using JWT authentication.

- Optimized cPanel/WHM environments with automated backup solutions, security hardening, and custom cron-based deployment scripts.
- Refactored legacy WordPress codebases into modern, component-driven architectures using best practices for SEO, accessibility, and cross-browser support.
- Mentored junior developers on Git workflows, WP-CLI, and debugging practices, contributing to a 50% increase in deployment velocity.

Software Engineer

Syscom Digital

October 2019 – August 2021

Bucharest, Romania (Remote)

- Designed custom plugins for WooCommerce to manage user-submitted product reviews, dynamic pricing, and tiered discounts for B2B clients.
- Integrated third-party APIs such as Stripe, PayPal, Mailchimp, and SendGrid with robust error handling and webhook systems.
- Maintained WordPress multisite setups with isolated environments for localized SEO and analytics tracking using Google Tag Manager.
- Implemented full-stack solutions for marketing campaigns using WordPress backends and Vue.js frontends, increasing lead conversion by 23%.
- Created AI-powered landing pages that dynamically adjusted messaging using natural language content scoring algorithms via OpenAI.
- Containerized staging environments using Docker for plugin QA testing and feature previews, reducing QA cycles by 40%.
- Configured automatic deployment pipelines and SSL renewals for cPanel servers using shell scripts and Certbot.
- Conducted performance audits and improved Google Lighthouse scores across all sites, pushing mobile scores to above 95 consistently.

Software Developer

Soft Build

June 2016 – July 2019

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Developed and maintained over 25 WordPress websites with custom Gutenberg blocks, tailored to diverse industries including retail, healthcare, and fintech.
- Built WooCommerce-powered online stores integrated with dynamic tax calculators and payment gateways across EU and US markets.
- Deployed content automation scripts using Python to scrape and populate product databases, reducing manual content entry by 80%.
- Customized Elementor templates for enterprise clients, building dynamic templates using ACF + JetEngine + CPT UI for scalable content control.
- Automated database backups and file syncs across staging and live environments using bash scripting and remote MySQL replication.
- Contributed to Shopify theme customization projects, adjusting Liquid templates and extending frontend features with JavaScript.
- Created AI-driven recommendation modules for eCommerce sites, enhancing customer retention and boosting average order value.
- Enhanced cross-device responsiveness and implemented accessibility improvements, ensuring compliance with WCAG 2.1 standards.

Software Developer
Decima Digital
November 2015 – April 2016
Tallinn, Estonia

- Delivered custom WordPress themes for marketing agencies and integrated SEO frameworks using Yoast and custom schema.
- Developed WooCommerce add-ons for booking and reservation systems using custom post types and AJAX-powered interfaces.
- Monitored site security using Wordfence, setting up automated reports, and hardened server configurations at the cPanel level.
- Implemented custom XML and JSON data feeds for third-party affiliate platforms using cron jobs and RESTful APIs.
- Introduced AI-powered FAQ bots embedded into client WordPress sites using Dialogflow and Google Cloud Functions.
- Applied on-page SEO best practices and ensured fast mobile-first designs using image lazy-loading and asset minification.
- Supported plugin conflict resolution and cross-theme compatibility testing for clients with diverse plugin stacks.
- Engaged in agile workflows with global teams, delivering work across Jira and GitHub with regular sprint reviews.

Software Developer Intern
Borna Technology
September 2014 – August 2015
Tallinn, Estonia (On-Site)

- Assisted in developing internal WordPress tools for a real estate CRM, including property search widgets and API integrations.
- Created and maintained HTML email templates with dynamic WordPress content and Mailchimp sync using WP REST endpoints.
- Optimized WordPress media management via server-level scripts to compress and resize images in real time.
- Helped launch an internal intranet portal on a headless WordPress + Vue.js stack for internal company documentation.
- Wrote documentation for custom plugins and internal development guidelines aimed at improving team onboarding.
- Automated sitemap generation and SEO audits using cron + XML + Screaming Frog reports.
- Conducted QA testing across all browsers and responsive breakpoints with manual and Selenium-based automated tests.
- Learned Agile, Git, and server deployment practices that laid the foundation for future professional development.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- ❖ WordPress Theme & Plugin Development – Udemy
 - ❖ Advanced WooCommerce Customization – LinkedIn Learning
 - ❖ AI-Powered Web Experiences with OpenAI – Coursera
 - ❖ AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner – Amazon
 - ❖ Google Cloud Digital Leader – GCP
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PROJECTS

- ✓ **WooAI – AI-Powered eCommerce Assistant**
Developed a WordPress plugin that integrates OpenAI GPT to offer product recommendations, auto-descriptions, and chatbot support inside WooCommerce.
- ✓ **InstaSEO – Performance & SEO Automation for WordPress**
Created a plugin that audits websites for SEO best practices, fixes image compression, alt texts, minifies CSS/JS, and automatically updates sitemaps.
- ✓ **ElementorKit – Custom Widgets & Template Pack**
Built a reusable Elementor widget set and starter template pack tailored for fast onboarding of client websites in real estate and hospitality.
- ✓ **WP CRM Syncer**
A plugin that connects WooCommerce orders and customer data to HubSpot, Mailchimp, and other CRMs using REST API and OAuth authentication.